

Lesson Plans

Lesson 1 · Theme Warm-up: Hard Times Vocabulary (40 min)

Target language: Key vocabulary for describing hardship and overcoming challenges.

Materials: Vocabulary handout, Board, Projector (optional)

1. **5 min** Warm-up: ask students to brainstorm words connected to 'hard times' in English or Turkish. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Present key vocabulary with example sentences from the vocabulary list. (T-S)
3. **10 min** Students match words to Turkish meanings and definitions in pairs. (Pairs)
4. **10 min** Students use 5 new words to talk about hardships they have heard of, in pairs. (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Whole-class feedback and correction of common vocabulary errors. (T-S)

Assessment: Monitor pair work and check vocabulary matching answers.

Support: Provide a shorter list of 10 core words for support students.

Core: Full 22-word list with pair practice.

Extension: Ask stronger students to create one original sentence per word.

Homework: Match remaining vocabulary words to meanings at home.

Lesson 2 · Past Simple: Noticing and Rules (40 min)

Target language: Past simple (regular and irregular) for finished past actions.

Materials: Grammar handout g1, Board

1. **5 min** Show notice sentences from g1 and ask students what they notice about the verb forms. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Present the past simple rule (positive, negative, question forms). (T-S)
3. **10 min** Complete gap-fill items from g1 discover.complete individually, then check in pairs.
(Individual/Pairs)
4. **10 min** Build sentences from cues (g1 discover.build) in pairs. (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Review common mistakes from g1.mistakes on the board. (T-S)

Assessment: Check gap-fill and sentence-building answers.

Support: Focus support students on regular verbs only.

Core: Full range of regular and irregular verbs.

Extension: Ask stronger students to write 3 original past simple sentences about a hardship.

Homework: Complete g1 practice items 1-4 at home.

Lesson 3 • Past Simple Practice and Pronunciation (40 min)

Target language: Past simple regular verb endings and questions/answers about the past.

Materials: Grammar handout g1 practice/challenge, Audio examples (optional)

1. **5 min** Review past simple form with a quick oral drill. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Present and practise -ed pronunciation categories with example verbs. (T-S)
3. **10 min** Complete g1 practice items individually. (Individual)
4. **10 min** In pairs, ask and answer past simple questions about hardships people might face (using S1 outcome). (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Whole-class check of practice answers. (T-S)

Assessment: Check practice item answers and monitor pronunciation during pair work.

Support: Provide a pronunciation chart with example words grouped by sound.

Core: Standard practice items and pair questions.

Extension: g1 challenge items for early finishers.

Homework: Complete g1 challenge items at home.

Lesson 4 • Past Continuous: Noticing and Rules (40 min)

Target language: Past continuous for actions in progress at a specific past moment.

Materials: Grammar handout g2, Board

1. **5 min** Show notice sentences from g2 and ask what students notice about was/were + -ing. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Present the past continuous rule (positive, negative, question forms). (T-S)
3. **10 min** Complete gap-fill items from g2 discover.complete. (Individual/Pairs)
4. **10 min** Pair practice: 'What were you doing at 8 p.m. yesterday?' using S2 outcome. (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Review common mistakes from g2.mistakes. (T-S)

Assessment: Check gap-fill answers and monitor pair Q&A.

Support: Provide sentence frames: 'At ____, I was ____.'

Core: Full range of subjects and verbs.

Extension: Ask stronger students to add a reason clause with 'because'.

Homework: Complete g2 practice items 1-3 at home.

Lesson 5 · Past Continuous with 'while' (40 min)

Target language: Two past actions happening at the same time, linked with 'while'.

Materials: Grammar handout g2 build/compare, Board

1. **5 min** Review past continuous form with a quick oral drill. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Present g2 compare table: past simple vs past continuous, focus on 'while' sentences. (T-S)
3. **10 min** Build 'while' sentences from cue cards (g2 discover.build) in pairs. (Pairs)
4. **10 min** Complete g2 practice items individually, then check as a class. (Individual)
5. **5 min** Quick oral round: each student says one 'while' sentence about their own past. (T-S)

Assessment: Check 'while' sentence accuracy during pair work and oral round.

Support: Give sentence halves to match instead of building from scratch.

Core: Standard cue-card building and practice items.

Extension: g2 challenge items for early finishers.

Homework: Complete g2 challenge items at home.

Lesson 6 · Reading: The Girl Who Didn't Stop (40 min)

Target language: Reading a biographical text using past simple and past continuous in context.

Materials: Reading text r1 (printed or projected), Question handout

1. **5 min** Pre-reading: discuss the before questions for r1. (T-S)
2. **15 min** Students read r1 individually and underline unfamiliar words. (Individual)
3. **5 min** Pair check: guess the meaning of unfamiliar words from context. (Pairs)
4. **10 min** Complete comprehension questions for r1 individually, then check as a class. (Individual)
5. **5 min** Post-reading discussion using the after prompts for r1. (Pairs)

Assessment: Check comprehension question answers.

Support: Pre-teach 5 key words before reading and allow extra reading time.

Core: Full text and question set.

Extension: Ask stronger students to summarise the text in 3 sentences using their own words.

Homework: Reread r1 and write 2 new questions about it to bring to the next lesson.

Lesson 7 · Reading: From the Repair Shop to the Stage (40 min)

Target language: Reading a biographical text and identifying the sequence of past events.

Materials: Reading text r2 (printed or projected), Question handout

1. **5 min** Pre-reading: discuss the before questions for r2. (T-S)
2. **15 min** Students read r2 individually and note the order of key events. (Individual)
3. **10 min** In pairs, retell the sequence of events using past simple and past continuous. (Pairs)
4. **5 min** Complete comprehension questions for r2. (Individual)
5. **5 min** Post-reading discussion using the after prompts for r2. (Pairs)

Assessment: Check comprehension answers and monitor sequencing retell.

Support: Provide a simple timeline template to fill in while reading.

Core: Full text, sequencing, and question set.

Extension: Ask stronger students to predict what Kerem might do next in his career.

Homework: Write a 3-sentence summary of r2's sequence of events.

Lesson 8 · Used to: Noticing and Rules (40 min)

Target language: 'Used to' for past habits and states that are no longer true.

Materials: Grammar handout g3, Board

1. **5 min** Show notice sentences from g3 and ask what students notice about 'used to'. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Present the 'used to' rule (positive, negative, question forms) and the compare table with past simple. (T-S)
3. **10 min** Complete gap-fill items from g3 discover.complete. (Individual/Pairs)
4. **10 min** Pair interview: 'What did you use to do as a young child?' using S3 outcome. (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Review common mistakes from g3.mistakes. (T-S)

Assessment: Check gap-fill answers and monitor interview accuracy.

Support: Give sentence frames: 'I used to ____, but now I ____.'

Core: Full range of subjects and past habits.

Extension: Ask stronger students to add a reason for the change with 'because'.

Homework: Complete g3 practice items 1-3 at home.

Lesson 9 · Listening and Speaking: Hard Times Conversation (40 min)

Target language: Listening for gist and detail; discussing hardships and how people adapt.

Materials: Listening transcript I1 (read aloud by teacher or two students), Question handout

1. **5 min** Pre-listening: discuss the pre prompts for I1. (T-S)
2. **10 min** Play/read the I1 transcript once for gist; students note the general topic. (Individual)
3. **10 min** Play/read again; students answer comprehension questions for I1. (Individual)
4. **10 min** Pair discussion using the post prompts for I1, connecting to Speaking task s1. (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Whole-class feedback and answer check. (T-S)

Assessment: Check listening comprehension answers and monitor speaking discussion.

Support: Give students the transcript to read while listening.

Core: Standard listening and discussion.

Extension: Ask stronger students to summarise speaker A's story in their own words without notes.

Homework: Write 3 sentences about your own experience of adapting to a hard situation.

Lesson 10 · Speaking Workshop and Writing Preparation (40 min)

Target language: Speaking about past hardships and habits; planning a piece of writing.

Materials: Speaking task s1 and s2 handouts, Writing plan template for w1

1. **10 min** Run speaking task s1: 'My Family's Story' interviews in pairs. (Pairs)
2. **10 min** Run speaking task s2: 'Then and Now' discussion in small groups. (Groups of 3-4)
3. **5 min** A few groups report their most interesting example to the class. (T-S)
4. **10 min** Introduce writing task w1 and complete the planning steps together. (Individual)
5. **5 min** Peer-check plans in pairs before the next lesson's writing. (Pairs)

Assessment: Monitor speaking tasks for accurate use of past forms; check writing plans.

Support: Provide question starters and sentence frames for speaking and planning.

Core: Standard speaking tasks and writing plan.

Extension: Ask stronger students to prepare a 'while' sentence and a 'used to' sentence for their plan.

Homework: Finish the writing plan for w1 at home, ready to write next lesson.

Lesson 11 · Writing Task and Theme Review (40 min)

Target language: Writing a short biographical paragraph using past simple, past continuous, and 'used to'.

Materials: Writing task w1 handout, Checklist, Review question set

1. **5 min** Quick review game using review vocabulary and grammar questions. (T-S)
2. **20 min** Students write the w1 biographical paragraph individually, using their plan from lesson 10.
(Individual)
3. **5 min** Students self-check their writing using the w1 checklist. (Individual)
4. **5 min** Peer feedback in pairs: check for at least one past simple, one past continuous, and one 'used to' sentence. (Pairs)
5. **5 min** Wrap-up: complete a few review items orally as a class and preview homework. (T-S)

Assessment: Assess final paragraphs against the w1 checklist for grammar accuracy and organisation.

Support: Provide sentence starters and a shorter word count target (80-100 words).

Core: Standard 120-150 word paragraph.

Extension: Ask stronger students to add a second paragraph describing how the person's story could inspire others.

Homework: Complete homework core/extension tasks and finalise the paragraph for submission.